

Joint A connection between two bones.

Keratin A tough, waterproof protein found in hair, nails, and the upper layer of your skin.

Ligament A tough band of tissue that connects bones where they meet at joints.

Limbic system A cluster of structures inside your brain that are vital in creating emotions, memory, and the sense of smell.

Lymphatic system A network of vessels that collect fluid from body tissues and filter it for germs, before returning the fluid to the bloodstream.

Lymphocyte A white blood cell that specializes in attacking a specific kind of germ. Some lymphocytes make antibodies.

Macrophage A white blood cell that swallows and destroys germs such as bacteria, cancer cells, or debris in damaged tissue.

Magnetic Resonance Imaging (MRI) A scanning technique that uses magnetism, radio waves, and a computer to produce images of the inside of the body.

Melanin A brown-black pigment that is found in your skin, hair, and eyes and gives them their color.

Metabolism A term used to describe all the chemical reactions going on inside your body, especially within cells.

Mind The thoughts, feelings, beliefs, ideas, and sense of self that are generated by the brain make up what we call the mind.

Mineral A naturally occurring solid chemical, such as salt, calcium, or iron, that you need to eat to stay healthy.

Mitochondrion (plural **Mitochondria**) A tiny structure found inside cells that releases energy from sugar.

Mitosis The division of a body cell into two new, identical cells.

Molecule A single particle of a particular chemical compound. A molecule is a cluster of atoms (the smallest particles of an element) bonded together permanently.

Motor neuron A type of nerve cell that carries nerve impulses from your central nervous system to your muscles.

Mucus Slippery liquid found on the inside of your nose, throat, and intestines.

Muscle A body part that contracts (gets shorter) to move your bones or internal organs.

Muscle fiber A muscle cell.

Nerve cell See neuron.

Nerve impulse A tiny electrical signal that is transmitted along a nerve cell (neuron) at high speed.

Neuron Another word for a nerve cell. Neurons carry information around your body as electrical signals.

Neurotransmitter A chemical created by nerve cells (neurons) that relays signals across the tiny gaps (synapses) between one neuron and another.

Nucleus The control center of a cell. It contains DNA-carrying chromosomes.

Nutrients The basic chemicals that make up food. Your body uses nutrients for fuel, growth, and repair.

Organ A group of tissues that form a body part designed for a specific job. Your heart is an organ.

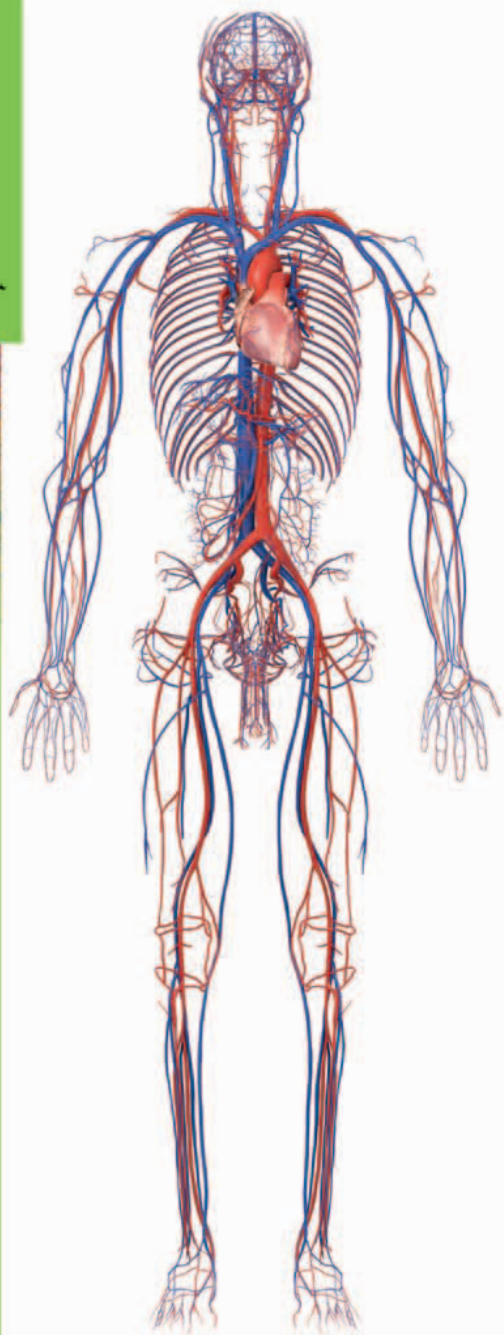
Organelle A tiny structure inside a cell that carries out an important role. The nucleus is an organelle that contains genetic information.

Ovum Also called an egg, this is the female sex cell, which is produced by, and released from, a woman's ovary.

Oxygen A gas, found in air, that is vital for life. Oxygen is breathed in, absorbed by the blood, and used by cells to release energy from glucose (a simple sugar).

Pathogen A microorganism that causes disease. Pathogens are also called germs and include bacteria and viruses.

Peristalsis The wave of muscular squeezes (contractions) in the wall of a hollow organ that, for example, pushes food down the esophagus during swallowing.



▲ **CIRCULATION** Your heart pumps blood around your body through a vast network of tubes called blood vessels.